

Final Project Report

Design System Summary, Challenges, Outcomes & Reflection

PROJECT	TRACE — Understanding Microplastics. Taking Action.
TRACK	Graphic Design
TEAM	Alaa Mosaad · Asmaa Yasser · Zeina Mohamed · Shahd Mahmoud · Abdelrahman Karam · Mohamed Osama
SUPERVISOR	Dr. Suzan Farahat
SOURCE MATERIAL	Project Proposal.pdf, Trace Presentation.pdf (Brand Identity & Strategy Presentation)

Understanding Microplastics. Taking Action.

7.1 Executive Summary

TRACE is a Graphic Design track project delivering a complete brand identity and UX/UI design system for a fictional AI-powered wellness platform aimed at helping eco-conscious young adults understand and reduce their daily exposure to microplastics. Rather than building the underlying scanning technology, this project's contribution is the visual and experiential design layer: the identity, the interface, and the applied collateral that make TRACE's message trustworthy, premium, and actionable.

7.2 Design System Overview

The identity is built on a deep-teal-and-aqua color system, a Clash Display / Inter typography pairing, and a particle-core arch “A” mark developed through three documented rounds of exploration (Document 05, §5.2). This foundation was applied consistently across five touchpoints: a mobile app (six core screens across a Learn → Scan → Take Action → Community flow), a marketing website, a social media template set, a merchandise line, and a business card — all documented in full in the brand guidelines manual (Document 06).

7.3 Development Journey

PHASE	WHAT HAPPENED
Planning	Team roles assigned across 7 members; timeline and KPIs set (Document 01).
Research	Persona (Shorouk), problem statement, and SWOT analysis established the brand's strategic foundation (Document 02).
Design analysis	Moodboard and wireframes translated strategy into a visual and UX direction (Document 03).
Production	Logo finalized after three exploration rounds; all touchpoint mockups produced using the toolkit in Document 04.
QA & reporting	Consistency and accessibility audits completed; brand guidelines manual and this report finalized (Documents 05–07).

7.4 Challenges & Solutions

CHALLENGE	DESIGN SOLUTION
Microplastics is an anxiety-inducing, technical subject that risks disengagement	Adopted an “empowerment over guilt” voice and a premium biohacking visual language instead of eco-NGO guilt-tripping.
The target persona is highly budget-conscious, limiting how “aspirational” the brand could look without feeling out of touch	Paired the premium visual system with content strategy foregrounding free/low-cost habit swaps.
Bilingual (English/Arabic) requirements added typesetting complexity to the identity	Tested and validated an Arabic wordmark treatment during logo Round 2, then carried bilingual layout rules into merchandise and business card design.
Risk that AI-scanning claims in the copy could overstate a capability this design-only project doesn't build	Locked a copy rule requiring qualified language (“estimated”, “detected”) everywhere the product's AI function is referenced.

7.5 Deliverables Summary

- Project Documentation set — this 7-document package (Documents 01–07).
- Brand Identity & Strategy Presentation (*Trace Presentation.pdf*) — the master visual deliverable: team, strategy, moodboard, logo development, and every application mockup.
- Brand Guidelines Manual (Document 06) — the standalone usage reference.

7.6 Team Reflection

The seven-person structure (Document 01, §1.3) split research, content, visual design, UX, data, and operations into distinct but tightly coordinated ownership areas, with the supervisor gating each of the five milestones. This kept the brand strategy, visual identity, and applied UX design consistent with one another from the first moodboard through to the final guidelines manual.

CLOSING NOTE

A premium identity, built without guilt — because the science was already frightening enough.

7.7 Conclusion

TRACE demonstrates that a technically dense, anxiety-adjacent subject can be given a coherent, premium graphic identity that respects its audience's intelligence, budget, and skepticism of greenwashing — without ever building the underlying software. The identity system, UX design, and applied collateral produced here are ready to guide any future software implementation of the TRACE concept.